I.S.T.A.R FACILITIES

Dungeon Master Notes from PAX East 2016

The new I.S.T.A.R facilities ensure that the Zhentarim employ only the highest quality merchants and mercenaries. But something's gone wrong. As a high ranking member of the Black Network, it's up to you to travel through the training facilities and figure out what needs to be done to get them up and running again.

A 2-hour Adventure for Woefully Unprepared 7th level Characters

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Introduction

Welcome to *I.S.T.A.R Facilities*, a short D&D experience that captures the details of Patrick Rothfuss's adventure run at the Acquisitions Incorporated live game at PAX East 2016.

This experience is designed for four less than optimal 7th level characters played for entertainment purposes. Characters outside of this range will likely stomp all over your carefully laid plans.

The adventure takes place in a hidden facility that could be found in any city on Faerûn.

Notes, Not an Adventure

What you're reading is an edited version of Patrick Rothfuss's Dungeon Master notes from PAX East 2016. Like most DMs that create an adventure for their friends, these notes cover the basics of what the characters may encounter, along with some challenge ratings and monsters that we hoped would be a good, fun experience based on what we knew of those characters.

We've taken what Patrick wrote, added a few details and formatted it to be more accessible to everyone. This still leaves a lot of details open for you to fill in or alter to make it more fun for your group.

On a final note, the names of those involved in this adventure have been changed to protect the innocent, and the not so innocent. We decided to use the Zhentarim because it fit well thematically. Feel free to use whatever group or guild fits best for your campaign.

Preparing the Adventure

Before you show up to Dungeon Master this adventure for a group of players, you should do the following to prepare.

- Make sure to have a copy of the most current version of the *D&D Basic Rules* or the *Player's Handbook*.
- Read through the adventure, taking notes of anything you'd like to highlight or remind yourself while running the adventure, such as a way you'd like to portray an NPC or a tactic you'd like to use in a combat.
- Get familiar with the monster statistics in the Appendix.
- Gather together any resources you'd like to use to aid you in running this adventure--such as notecards, a DM screen, miniatures, and battlemaps.
- If you know the composition of the group beforehand, you can make adjustments as noted throughout the adventure.

Before Play at the Table

Ask the players to provide you with relevant character information:

- Character name and level
- Character race and class
- Passive Wisdom (Perception)—the most common passive ability check
- Anything notable as specified by the adventure (such as backgrounds, traits, flaws, etc.)

Adjusting the Adventure

This experience was initially designed for the live D&D game at PAX East 2016. It's likely that you'll need or want to adjust the DCs and challenge ratings for your own table. Please reference the Dungeon Master's Guide for guidelines on making those adjustments.

Background

Dread Lord Riavi has been on sabbatical from running the local Zehantarim guild house ever since that unfortunate incident with Guild Office Manager Kleff. Most people don't know the exact details, but a few months back some Harper agents managed to infiltrate the guild house and stole some documents. In the process, Kleff was killed and Riavi was injured.

Riavi has designated the members of the party as his temporary replacements while he's away. If the party does well in Riavi's absence, they're all but guaranteed promotions within the Black Network.

It's been a few weeks and everything has gone swimmingly – bossing around the underlings, kicking back and raking in a percentage of the spoils! Life at the top is good, and everything seems to be going fine until that flashing light goes off.

Overview

While sitting in for Dread Lord Riavi, the party members are alerted to a problem with something called the I.S.T.A.R system. They investigate, discovering that I.S.T.A.R is a training program

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started by Dread Lord Riavi. This new system seems to be completely off the books.

Needing to ensure that everything continues running smoothly so they can get their promotions, the party heads into the I.S.T.A.R facility to determine what's gone wrong and fix it before Riavi's return. The party manages their way through each room in the training facility only to be confronted by the final challenge – a flesh golem version of Kleff.

The I.S.T.A.R. Facilities

One of the Zhentarim underlings approaches the team, letting them know that there's a flashing light on a control board. Apparently there's been a "Budget Overrun" in the ISTAR Facility.

A little digging reveals that ISTAR stands for Intern Selection Training and Ranking.

The Zhentarim have an intern testing facility? Apparently so. Apparently it's something that Riavi has been developing to streamline the process of acquiring new interns.

Dread Lord Riavi has instructed that he be contacted personally when this light goes off, but the underlings thought they should bring it to the party instead of trying to contact their vacationing leader. So if the team wants to know what's going on there, they have to head over and check it out themselves….

The facility is on the other side of town from the local Zhentarim headquarters, so after a short walk the party arrives.

Entryway

Following the directions given to them leads the party to a dark alley in the bad part of town. A bronze plaque next to a wooden door says Intern Selection Training and Ranking facility.

Inside is a small, windowless room. There is a stack of liability waivers on a table, and metal turn style that blocks the entrance to the next room. There is a sign that says, "Please insert Signed Waiver and intern application fee (100 GP or equivalent) into the slot below."

There is also a small speaker grille set into the wall, next to it is a small flashing red light similar to the one on the Zhentarim control board.

If the players insert 100 GP or equivalent in the slot, they will get a token that allows them to move through the turnstyle into the next room. As they do so, a mechanical voice crackles out of a nearby metal grille (read the text aloud):

> "Thank you for participating in the ISTAR program.
>
> You may be held liable for damage to ISTAR facilities or employees.
>
> Please keep in mind that your training process will be monitored for quality control and training purposes.
>
> We are not responsible for any lingering injuries or trauma.
>
> If you experience an erection lasting more than four hours… "
>
> A long list of legal disclaimers continues to stream from the grille as the party continues on.

Testing Room 1: Catchphrase Room

This is a large room laid out like a tavern. There is a long bar, many tables, a fireplace, and a set of stairs that leads to an upper floor balcony.

Crude training dummies are set up at various points in the room: Two patron dummies at the bar. Four card-playing dummies at a table. A musician dummy at the fireside. An innkeeper dummy.

There is a chandelier here.

> A mechanical voice comes through the speaking grille overhead:
>
> "Interning with the Black Network is a rare and prestigious opportunity that requires more than just the ability to fight, perform magic, or disarm traps. Zhentarim interns must also be able to execute their duties with a certain degree of flair and style.
>
> In this room you will demonstrate your ability to attack an enemy while using a catchphrase.
>
> You will be graded on originality and delivery."

Whenever a party member attacks one of the target dummies while uttering a catch phrase, a ding sounds over the loudspeaker. The mechanical voice may also comment on their actions. Once all party members have done this at least one, the door to the next room opens.

As the DM, give points or grades however makes you happy. Have the robotic voice praise or mock the players as appropriate. As Dread Lord Riavi loves swinging from chandeliers, extra points should be awarded for use of the chandelier.

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Testing Room 2: Treasure Room

This is a large open room with a dotted line painted across the far end. Across the line there is a large hopper. Near the entrance where the characters are, there are several separate areas of note:

- A large open chest filled with what look like bars of dwarven steel (100 bars)
- A small table with some gold pieces scattered atop it, along with several large sacks
- A small mockup of a wizard's lab with a table full of equipment and a bookshelf
- A shelf full of small statues and jewelry
- A large banquet table with food and expensive looking cutlery
- A jeweled crown and scepter on the wall

There is a chandelier here.

> As you're looking over the items of the room, the mechanical voice addresses you again.
>
> "Style isn't enough to pay the bills, and as an intern, you are partially responsible for the financial well-being of the Black Network.
>
> In this room, you will demonstrate your ability to quickly and efficiently gather treasure. You will have one minute to bring as much treasure as possible across the finish line.
>
> You will be graded based on value of materials acquired, and ranked in comparison to the rest of your intern training group."

The players are given one minute to grab treasure and get it across the finish line. For purposes of this event, grabbing items from one of the different areas is an action, and it requires the players full move to get to the hopper and drop off the items. It's another move action to move back to any of the areas of the room that hold items. Investigating or making knowledge checks is an action. Each different area has its own challenges, as follows.

Feel free to add different items, challenges and skills to your treasure room based on the kinds of things you know will appeal to your players and their characters.

1. The Chest

The bars of dwarven steel are incredibly heavy and it will require a significant feat of strength to pick up and move them. The amount of bars a character can pick up and move in a turn is dependent on their **Strength (Athletics)** check:

- **DC 10** – Pick up/move 1 bar
- **DC 12** – Pick up/move 2 bars
- **DC 14** – Pick up/move 3 bars
- **DC 16** – Pick up/move 4 bars
- **DC 18** – Pick up/move 5 bars
- **DC 20+** – Pick up/move 6 bars

A **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation)** reveals that the bars are worth 20 gp each. Dwarves would know this without making a check. If you think another check would apply to appraise the bars, the DC is 15.

2. The Wizard's Lab

Most of the gear in the workshop area is of little value. There are three main areas of focus/investigation: the books, the alchemical equipment and the potions. For the books, **Intelligence (Arcana)**, **Intelligence (History)** or **Intelligence (Investigation)** checks reveal:

- **DC 14**: A book worth 80 gp
- **DC 16**: A book worth 120 gp
- **DC 18**: Both books (200 gp total)
- After making a check, a character gains a +2 bonus if they make the check again on a later turn.

For the alchemical equipment, a **DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation)** or **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** reveals a few pieces that are worth 50 gp combined.

For the potions, there are several scattered across the table. Only three of them are worth anything (100 gp each) but they're difficult for your average adventurer to identify. A successful **DC 16 Intelligence (Arcana)** or **Intelligence (Investigation)** reveals one of the potions. They can search for more potions on a subsequent turn.

Alternately, the player may sample a bottle to determine if it's worth anything. If they do so, roll percentile. There's a 20% chance that they take a sip of one of these helpful potions and are fine. If you roll the other 80%, they suffer some annoying but not completely debilitating effect. Examples include:

- Everything smells like bubble gum
- You don't understand any spoken language
- You see faeries everywhere
- You become colorblind
- You can't stop laughing
- You look like a flumph but retain all your stats/abilities
- You grow an extra finger on each hand

These are all just examples, feel free to add your own flavor. These effects all last for one minute, or if you're feeling like you can use them as a future adventure hook, as long as you want.

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3. The Crown and Scepter

These items aren't actually mounted on the wall – they are contained in a gelatinous cube. If someone approaches the crown and scepter, just before they touch the creature, if they have a light source and a **Passive Pereception of 15** or higher (no light source is a **Passive Perception of 18**), they see the gelatinous cube. Otherwise if they try to investigate or otherwise inspect the crown and scepter, they step into the cube and are attacked by it in a surprise round. After this, the cube will not move, but it will attack anybody who comes near it and its treasures. Refer to the monster appendix. The crown and scepter are worth 2000 gp combined.

4. The Banquet Table

Anyone looking to loot the banquet table will require a **DC 15 Intelligence** (**Investigation)** to identify the most valuable loot, (4 Silver candelabras worth 80GP each and 4 serving platters worth 75 GP each). Whoever ate here last left everything quite greasy. If a character tries to take more than one of these items at a time, they must make a Dexterity Save DC determined by how many items they're trying to carry. If they fail, they drop half of the items and must return for them.

- 1-2 items – **Dexterity Save DC 14**
- 3-4 items – **Dexterity Save DC 16**
- 4-5 items – **Dexterity Save DC 18**
- 6-7 items – **Dexterity Save DC 20**
- 8 items -- **Dexterity Save DC 21**

If they fail the save by 5 or more, they fall halfway to the hopper, dropping everything. If they fail by 10 or more, they drop everything right as the start, on or near the table.

5. Shelves of Figurines and Jewelry

The shelves full of figurines and jewelry are cheap imitation crap, and are worthless. This is determined after a **DC 12 (Investigation)**.

6. Table with Sacks and Coins

The sacks sitting on the table are quite hefty and obviously filled with coins. Investigating a sack takes an action but reveals that it is filled with copper pieces and sand (total value 30 GP.) Each sack is like this, but the character won't know that unless they investigate each one.

A **DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) or Passive Perception 18** reveals that the table itself is quite a nice piece of furniture, and is worth 100 gp. Anyone with a strength of 10 or higher can move the table to the hopper in one turn. A character with less than 10 strength needs to make a **DC 10 Strength (Athletics)** check to move it. If they fail, they can drag it at half speed, taking two moves to get to the hopper.

Tallying the Results!

Once time is up, an annoying tone blares throughout the room. A "ka-ching ka-ching" sound comes from within the hopper as it tallies the results. When done, it spits out medallions with the characters' names on them based on the value of what they turned in.

- Players turning in 1000 GP worth of goods receive a gold medallion.
- Players turning in 500 GP worth of goods receive a silver medallion.
- Players turning in 200 GP worth of goods receive a copper medallion
- Players turning in 50 GP worth of goods receive a steel medallion.
- Players turning in between 10-50 GP worth of treasure receive a tin metal labeled "Participant"

The door will not open for players if at least one of them does not possess at least a "Participant" medallion.

The player who gathers the most treasure will also receive a gold construction paper star, spit out from the hopper after tallying all the scores.

If anybody used the chandelier for any reason during the test, the hopper spits out a small Dread Lord Riavi action figure for that person.

> As you leave the room, you receive another message from the voice behind the metal grate.
>
> "Intern hopefuls are reminded that all treasure removed from the testing room will be transformed into venomous acid-infused spider-bees."

If someone removes treasure from the room, it turns into a swarm of venomous acid-infused spider-bees and after attacking the party once, dissipates in a foul smelling mist. Refer to the monster appendix.

Testing Room 3: Teambuilding Room

In front of the door leading to this room, there is a bowl with a number of stones equal to the number of party members, and a placard that reads "Please take one." A magical barrier prevents anyone from entering the room if they don't have a stone

This room consists of two balconies facing each other across a fifteen foot gap. It is a 20 foot fall to the floor below.

There are a lot of bones here.

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The voice from the metal grille fills the room.

> "Interns must be able to work toward a common goal. Using the tools provided, work with your fellow surviving interns to cross to the far side of the room.
>
> Due to your performance so far, each of you will be randomly assigned a performance countermeasure. This will hopefully allow you to showcase your ability to overcome obstacles and engage in lateral thinking.
>
> Lastly, note that magic has been deactivated in this room.

The tools can be found in wood containers near the door. They are:

- 100 feet of silk cord.
- 10 foot pole
- 50 hammers.
- A bedsheet.
- 7 six-foot planks of wood.
- Four 50 gallon barrels containing honey, vinegar, beer, and flour.
- 100 eighteen inch planks of wood
- 12 iron spikes
- A silver mirror

Performance countermeasures include, but are not limited to:

- Blind.
- Can only speak in rhyme
- One leg/arm turned to stone.
- Forced to carry a kitten. (Be warned, if at any point you are not carrying the kitten, you will be lit on fire.)

Magic has not actually been deactivated in this room. If they use magic to get across, they are praised for independent thought and given bonus points.

If the players start to take too long in the room, the voice will announce that a performance motivator is being activated, and in five minutes, spider wolves and ghost sharks will be released into the room to encourage further lateral thinking. Refer to the monster appendix

There is an invisible chandelier in the room. If the players discover it, they can easily swing to the other side with a **DC 8 Dexterity (Acrobatics).**

Mind the Gap

A fifteen foot gap isn't much of an obstacle. Most of the fun will come from the players having to deal with the sudden handicaps. There are plenty of ways for them to get across without building any sort of bridge. Reward ingenuity from the players, or be an unfair and vindictive god to them. It's your game.

Testing Room 5: The Emomel Memorial Acid Pit Training Room

Emomel was a favored intern who showed promise with the local Zhentarim. Unfortunately he had a fatal encounter with an acid trap. This room is the way Riavi chooses to honor Emomel's memory.

> As you enter the next room, you're assaulted with the caustic odor of strong acid. A green glow emanates from a large, liquid filled pit in the center of the room, creating rippling shadows that dance across the walls and ceiling. The voice from the metal grille addresses you again.
> "Due to an increase in acid related accidents and the subsequent insurance claims, we now require all hopeful interns to have a familiarity with acid pits and traps. This one's very simple - stay out of the acid. "

This is another large open room.

There is a chandelier here.

The players enter on a ledge that falls off after ten feet, dropping into a five foot deep pit filled with green acid. Glowing stones at the bottom of the acid pit give off the only light in the room. Jutting up from the pit are several islands and columns. All of these are square, ranging in size from only a couple feet wide to a few that are twenty feet wide.

There are quite a lot of bones in the acid pit.

It is up to the party members to find a path across the pit. Using nothing but their own abilities to move and jump, this will require various **Strength (Athletics)** or **Dexterity (Acrobatics)** checks ranging from **DC 10** to **DC 16.** Failure on these checks mean they fall into the acid. Certain spells may also prove useful, along with equipment and teamwork. There are various ways the players could get across, so this is another moment where the team's creativity could shine.

Once one of the members makes it across the pit, they find a ledge on the other side, along with a large gong. A **DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation)** reveals faint elven script etched along the outer edge of the gong. For those who understand elven, it reads:

"Whatever you do, if you value the life of your companions, DO NOT HIT THIS GONG!"

If someone hits the gong, some of the platforms lower into the acid pit. As the DM, you choose which

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of those platforms lower. Anyone on those platforms can make a **DC 14 Dexterity Save** to jump to a nearby platform.

If anybody falls into the acid at any point, they take 7 (or 2d6) points of acid damage. If a person starts their turn in the acid, they take 7 (or 2d6) points of acid damage. A person can climb out onto any adjacent platform with a **DC 10 Strength (Athletics)**. An adjacent ally can help them up, giving them advantage on the check. A person may pull an adjacent ally out of the acid by spending an action and succeeding on a **DC 14 Strength (Athletics)**.

Once everybody is across (or at least, everybody who's alive), the door opens to the next room.

Trust Falls, Performance Reviews, and Contract Negotiations

This is a large room. It contains a coffee machine, several beanbags, and a large desk with a swivel chair.

There is a chandelier here.

There are quite a lot of bones around here.

The all-to-familiar mechanical voice greets you once again. "Negotiating the fine points of your employment contract are an oft-overlooked part of intern training. But we here at ISTAR want you to be as prepared as possible. Please take this opportunity to enter into a trial negotiation with our state-of-the-art Negotiator simulacrum. Good luck and remember your training."

The swivel chair slowly turns, revealing a somewhat familiar figure.

It's Kleff!

Or at least it might be Kleff?

The figure looks a lot like Kleff, but it's clear that patches of skin from different creatures have been stitched together, and this thing is much larger and more intimidating that Kleff ever was.

Kleff, recognizing fellow Zhentarim who failed to save him, stands and attacks with a vengeance.

Refer to Kleff's stats in the monster appendix. Keep in mind that players who do not have magical weapons will not be able to damage the creature without spouting off a catch-phrase or biting words along with the attack, similar to what they learned in the first training room.

If they see that their attacks aren't doing any damage, you may need to jog their memories, or let them make a wisdom check DC 10 to see that there might have been more meaning to the mechanical voices reminder to "remember your training."

The chandelier in this room is purely decorative and cannot be cut free or swung from. Kleff has secured it.

If you think the fight is going to be too easy for the players or you just need some extra monsters to spice things up, skeletons wearing Zhentarim intern uniforms rise from the surrounding bone pits and attack alongside Kleff.

After you defeat Kleff, the mechanical voice returns, accompanied by a trumpet fanfare.

"Congratulations! You have completed the ISTAR program and your score has been recorded. Your application is on file, and you will be contacted with any employment opportunities as soon as they become available.

Remember, if you would like to improve your ISTAR score and rank, and therefore gain access to more lucrative interning opportunities, please feel free to return to the front foyer and complete the course again, honing your skills and refining your performance."

Risk and Reward

The party stands amidst the remains of fallen interns and the destroyed Kleff Golem. As they catch their breath, a secret door hidden in the room's back wall opens, and Dread Lord Riavi saunters in, whistling a carefree tune.

Seeing the party and the state they're in, Riavi explains that the "Budget Overrun" light just indicates the bin that collects the application fees is full again. He opens the compartment, revealing a large sack containing coins, gems, and other valuables. Among them, he finds a fancy looking new cloak, which he immediately dons. Flashing the party a big smile, he tosses the sack over his shoulder.

"Keep up the good work," Riavi says over his shoulder as he flips the party a platinum piece. He then saunters out of the facility.

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Appendix. NPC/Monster Statistics

Gelatinous Cube

Large ooze, unaligned

Armor Class 6
Hit Points 84 (8d10 + 40)
Speed 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	3 (-4)	20 (+5)	1 (-5)	6 (-2)	1 (-5)

Condition Immunities blinded, charmed, deafened, exhaustion, frightened, prone
Senses blindsight 60 ft. (blind beyond this radius), passive Perception 8
Languages --
Challenge 2 (450 XP)

Ooze Cube. The cube takes up its entire space. Other creatures can enter the space, but a creature that does so is subjected to the cube's Engulf and has disadvantage on the saving throw.

Creatures inside the cube can be seen but have total cover.

A creature within 5 feet of the cube can take an action to pull a creature or object out of the cube. Doing so requires a successful DC 12 Strength check, and the creature making the attempt takes 10 (3d6) acid damage.

The cube can hold only one Large creature or up to four Medium or smaller creatures inside it at a time.

Transparent: Even when the cube is in plain sight, it takes a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check to spot a cube that has neither moved nor attacked. A creature that tries to enter the cube's space while unaware of the cube is surprised by the cube.

Actions

Pseudopod. *Melee Weapon Attack*: +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) acid damage.

Engulf. *The cube moves up to its speed. While doing so, it can enter Large or smaller creatures' spaces. Whenever the cube enters a creature's space, the creature must make a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw.*

On a successful save, the creature can choose to be pushed 5 feet back or to the side of the cube. A creature that chooses not to be pushed suffers the consequences of a failed saving throw.

On a failed save, the cube enters the creature's space, and the creature takes 10 (3d6) acid damage and is engulfed. The engulfed creature can't breathe, is restrained, and takes 21 (6d6) acid damage at the start of each of the cube's turns. When the cube moves, the engulfed creature moves with it.

An engulfed creature can try to escape by taking an action to make a DC 12 Strength check. On a success, the creature escapes and enters a space of its choice within 5 feet of the cube.

Swarm of Venomous Acid-infused Spider-bees

Medium swarm of Tiny beasts, unaligned

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)
Hit Points 22 (5d8)
Speed 20 ft., climb 20 ft., fly 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
3 (-4)	13 (+1)	10 (+0)	1 (-5)	7 (-2)	1 (-5)

Damage Resistance bludgeoning, piercing, slashing
Damage Immunities acid, poison
Senses blindsight 10 ft., passive perception 8
Languages --
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature's space and vice versa, and the swarm can move through any opening large enough for a Tiny insect. The swarm can't regain hit points or gain temporary hit points.

Conjured Beasties. After attacking once, these creatures dissolve into a puff of foul smelling mist.

Actions

Bites. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 0 ft., one target in the swarm's space. *Hit:* 5 (2d4) acid damage and 5 (2d4) piercing damage, or 5 (2d4) piercing damage if the swarm has half of its hit points or fewer.

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Ghost Shark

Medium undead, unaligned

Armor Class 12 (natural armor)
Hit Points 22 (4d8+4)
Speed 0 ft., fly 40 ft., swim 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	13 (+1)	13 (+1)	1 (-5)	10 (-0)	4 (-3)

Skills Perception +2
Damage Resistances acid, fire, lightning, thunder; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical weapons
Damage Immunities cold, necrotic, poison
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, grappled, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned, prone, restrained
Senses blindsight 30 ft., passive Perception 12
Languages --
Challenge 1 (200 XP)
Pack Tactics. The ghost shark has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the ghost shark's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.
Ethereal Sight. The ghost shark can see 60 feet into the Ethereal Plane when it is on the Material Plane, and vice versa.
Incorporeal Movement. The ghost shark can move through other creatures and objects as if they were difficult terrain. It takes 5 (1d10) force damage if it ends its turn inside an object.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) necrotic damage.
Etherealness. The ghost shark enters the Ethereal Plane from the Material Plane, or vice versa. It is visible on the Material Plane while it is in the Border Ethereal, and vice versa, yet it can't affect or be affected by anything on the other plane.

Spider Wolf

Medium beast, unaligned

Armor Class 13 (natural armor)
Hit Points 11 (2d8+2)
Speed 40 ft., climb 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	3 (-4)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +4
Senses blindsight 10 ft., passive Perception 13
Languages --
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)
Keen Hearing and Smell. The spider wolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.
Pack Tactics. The spider wolf has advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the spider wolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally isn't incapacitated.
Web Sense. While in contact with a web, the spider wolf knows the exact location of any other creature in contact with the same web.
Web Walker. The spider ignores movement restrictions caused by webbing.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (2d4 + 2) piercing damage and the target must make a DC 11 Constitution saving throw, taking 9 (2d8) poison damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 11 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone. If the poison damage reduces the target to 0 hit points, the target is stable but poisoned for 1 hour, even after regaining hit points, and is paralyzed while poisoned in this way.

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Kleff Golem

Medium construct, neutral

Armor Class 9
Hit Points 93 (11d8 + 44)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	9 (-1)	18 (+4)	6 (-2)	10 (+0)	5 (-3)

Damage Immunities lightning, poison; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks not made with adamantine weapons
Condition Immunities charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 10
Languages Common
Challenge 5 (1800 XP)

Cutting Words Others can bypass the Kleff Golem's damage immunities by shouting a catchphrase or insult as they attack or cast a spell.

Berserk. Whenever the Kleff Golem starts its turn with 40 hit points or fewer, roll a d6. On a 6, the Kleff Golem goes berserk. On each of its turns while berserk, the Kleff Golem attacks the nearest creature it can see. If no creature is near enough to move to and attack, the Kleff Golem attacks an object, with preference for an object smaller than itself. Once the Kleff Golem goes berserk, it continues to do so until it is destroyed or regains all its hit points. The golem's creator, if within 60 feet of the berserk Kleff Golem, can try to calm it by speaking firmly and persuasively.

The Kleff Golem must be able to hear its creator, who must take an action to make a DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion) check. If the check succeeds, the Kleff Golem ceases being berserk. If it takes damage while still at 40 hit points or fewer, the Kleff Golem might go berserk again.

Aversion of Fire. If the Kleff Golem takes fire damage, it has disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks until the end of its next turn.

Immutable Form. The Kleff Golem is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.

Lightning Absorption. Whenever the Kleff Golem is subjected to lightning damage, it takes no damage and instead regains a number of hit points equal to the lightning damage dealt.

Magic Resistance. The Kleff Golem has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Magic Weapons. The Kleff Golem's weapon attacks are magical.

Actions

Multiattack. The Kleff Golem makes two slam attacks

Have a Magical Day Mother F***!*** (Recharges when hit with a spell attack or when a spell is successfully cast on the Kleff Golem) The Kleff Golem's hands start glowing. The next time the Kleff Golem hits with a slam attack, it deals an extra 9 (2d8) damage. If this slam attack hits a spellcaster, it removes one of the lowest level spell slots available from that caster, as if the caster had used it to cast a spell. As an example, if this attack were to hit a wizard who had a single 1st level spell slot still available, that slot would go away as if the wizard had cast a spell. The wizard would not be able to use that lost spell slot until undertaking an activity that would normally regain lost spell slots, such as a long rest.

Slam *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) bludgeoning damage.

Skeleton

Medium undead, lawful evil

Armor Class 13 (armor scraps)
Hit Points 13 (2d8+4)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)

Damage Vulnerabilities bludgeoning
Damage Immunities poison
Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned
Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9
Languages understands all languages it knew in life but can't speak
Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Actions

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Shortbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage

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